

Kamalesh Pagadala

Software Quality Engineering Leader | Test Automation | Quality Strategy

Los Angeles, CA | Kamalesh.pagadala@gmail.com | +1 (248) 826-3046 | [LinkedIn](#)

Software Quality Engineering Leader with **13+ years** of global experience in driving QA strategy, building scalable test automation frameworks, and leading high-performing engineering teams.

KEY EXPERTISE:

- **Test Automation & QA Strategy:** Selenium, Appium, RestAssured, Cucumber, JUnit, TestNG, Automation Roadmaps, Test Planning, Shift-Left Testing.
- **Performance & Reliability Engineering:** JMeter, Grafana K6, Load Testing, Monitoring (Datadog)
- **DevOps & CI/CD Integration:** Jenkins, CircleCI, GoCD, GitHub Actions, Bitbucket
- **Backend/API Testing & Development:** Java, Spring Boot, Node.js, Python, JavaScript, SQL, REST, GraphQL, API Automation, Microservices Testability
- **Leadership & Delivery:** Onshore/Offshore Team Mentoring, Agile (Scrum/Kanban), Quality Best Practices, Release Governance
- **Cloud & Tools:** AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, Postman, JIRA, Maven, Gradle, BrowserStack
- **Certifications:** AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, ISTQB Certified Test Engineer

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

FanDuel | Senior Software Engineer (QA & Test Automation Lead) | Aug 2022 – present

- **Architected and scaled** API and UI automation frameworks (Java, Spring Boot, RestAssured, Selenium, NightwatchJS), **increasing automation coverage by 40%**.
- **Established QA strategy** for FanDuel Racing, integrating test automation into CI/CD pipelines and streamlining workflows, which **shortened release cycles by 15%**.
- **Built a performance testing infrastructure** with Grafana K6 and custom dashboards, improving platform resilience and **reducing latency-related incidents by 25%**.
- **Mentored and led QA engineers**, defining automation best practices that **reduced production defects by 25%** and improved test reliability.
- **Collaborated with developers** to embed testability into microservices (Java 17, Spring Boot 3) and data workflows (SQL, GraphQL), ensuring higher system quality from design to deployment.
- Optimized **SQL stored procedures** and designed **custom GraphQL queries/schemas** to streamline test data validation, improving **automation flexibility and reducing execution time**.

Sony Interactive Entertainment | Senior Software Development Engineer in Test | May 2019 – Aug 2022

- **Built and scaled UI/API test automation frameworks** (Java, Cucumber, Selenium, RestAssured), to enhance Sony's global content pipeline, ensuring a seamless PS5 launch experience for millions of gamers worldwide.
- Played a critical role in the **PlayStation 5 launch**, delivering **end-to-end QA and automation support** for PlayStation Store and partner applications, achieving **99.9% uptime** during launch week.
- Owned the **automation framework architecture**, contributing to design and review discussions to drive innovation, maintainability, and efficiency across testing solutions.
- **Designed and executed test strategies** in qTest, achieving **95% coverage** across web and API services, significantly reducing production defects.
- Managed **onshore/offshore QA teams** and oversaw AWS/Jenkins deployments, ensuring smooth releases with **zero downtime**.

GearLaunch | *Lead Software Quality Engineer* | June 2017 – May 2019

- Built a **QA team from the ground up**, scaling to 10+ engineers and establishing a scalable quality strategy.
- Recruited, trained, and mentored engineers, fostering a **collaborative, quality-driven culture**.
- Defined and executed **functional, regression, and UAT test strategies** for the e-commerce platform.
- Designed and implemented a robust **UI automation framework (Selenium, Java, Cucumber)**, increasing automated coverage from **50% to 95%** and reducing manual effort significantly.
- Directed **end-to-end release and deployment cycles**, collaborating cross-functionally with developers, tech leads, and project managers to deliver high-quality releases on schedule.

GoPro | *Software Engineer* | August 2016 – May 2017

- Developed and maintained **backend RESTful APIs** using Java and Node.js in a **microservices architecture** deployed on Docker and Kubernetes.
- Automated **100+ API test cases** across microservices, enabling nightly execution and **reducing bug turnaround time by 30%**.
- Integrated automated tests into **Jenkins CI/CD pipelines**, cutting defect detection time from **days to hours** and accelerating release feedback loops.

ProQuest | *Software Test Engineer* | June 2014 - August 2016

- Developed and maintained **200+ UI automation tests** using Selenium WebDriver and JUnit, boosting test coverage for customer-facing modules by **70%** and reducing regression cycles by **30%**.
- Improved test execution reliability by troubleshooting automation failures, maintaining scripts, and running tests on cloud platforms via **Jenkins CI**.
- Built a **custom Java-based test metrics dashboard integrated with JIRA**, automating daily/weekly reporting and improving QA visibility by **80%**.

Compuware | *Software Test Engineer* | July 2012 – June 2014

- Developed **UI automation scripts** (Python, Selenium WebDriver) for the Identity & Access Management portal, raising functional test coverage by **60%** and reducing manual effort.
- Mentored a small QA team, standardizing automation practices across projects.
- Conducted **performance/load testing (JMeter, Gomez APM)**, improving response times by **25%**.

AppLabs | *Software Engineer* | Sep 2011 – July 2012

- Supported backend **Java development** with unit/integration tests to ensure system stability.
- Designed and executed functional/regression tests for enterprise claims-processing apps.
- Performed **load testing (JMeter)** and SOAP API validation (SOAPUI), improving system reliability.

EDUCATION:

Illinois Institute of Technology, Chicago, USA | *Master of Science in Computer Science* | 2011

Anna University, Chennai, India | *Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science* | 2008